

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 345

By Pody

A RESOLUTION to honor George McDonald upon his exemplary career as a farmer.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in recognizing a gentleman who has devoted his entire life to agriculture, the cornerstone of Tennessee's economy and the source of our long-held values of humility and industry; and

WHEREAS, a native of the Riddleton community in Smith County, George McDonald began his career as a farmer in 1978, when he was only eighteen years old; and

WHEREAS, Mr. McDonald's success in the agriculture industry is indeed impressive, and his time on the farm spans numerous trends and improvements in farming; and

WHEREAS, as a senior in high school, Mr. McDonald secured the triple crown of FFA by winning the State FFA Public Speaking Contest and the State FFA Farmer Award, in addition to serving as State FFA president; and

WHEREAS, he has been named the Tennessee Sunbelt Outstanding Farmer of the Year twice (1996 and 2024) and is a twelve-time winner of the National Corn Growers Yield Contest; and

WHEREAS, Mr. McDonald won the Tennessee Farm Bureau's Young Farmers and Ranchers Discussion Meet in 1985 and was honored with the American Farm Bureau's Young Farmer Achievement Award in 1990; and

WHEREAS, he continues to protect and preserve our farming heritage as a member of the Farmer Credit Mid-American Advocate Council and the University of Tennessee (UT) Extension's Smith County Row Crop Advisory Board and a trustee of the Tennessee Nature Conservancy; and

WHEREAS, George McDonald previously served the farming profession as chairman, vice chairman, and a board member of the UT College of Agricultural Sciences and Natural Resources Advisory Council, chairman of the Tennessee Corn Promotion Board, president of the Tennessee Fruit and Vegetable Association, and chairman of Tennessee Farm Bureau Feed Grains Committee; and

WHEREAS, Mr. McDonald is deeply attached to his native Smith County, and he has generously served his fellow citizens in numerous capacities, including as chairman of the Smith County Soil Conservation District, president and board member of the Smith County Farm Bureau, Smith County Chamber of Commerce, and Smith Farmers Co-op, and chairman of the Highway 25 Water Utility District; and

WHEREAS, he was deservedly honored as "Outstanding Citizen" by the Smith County Chamber of Commerce in 1991; and

WHEREAS, in 2023, George McDonald proudly hosted the U.S. House Agriculture Committee at his Catesa Farm, which will mark 100 years of family ownership in 2027 and qualify for certification as a Tennessee Century Farm; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his many accomplishments in agriculture, Mr. McDonald is most grateful for the love and companionship he shares with his family: wife, Susan McDonald; daughter, Celia McDonald Dillon; daughter, Sarah McDonald, who is an essential member of the family's farming operation; and mother, Linda McDonald; and

WHEREAS, George McDonald is a noble son of the soil who has endured times both good and bad to make his family's farm one of the most successful agriculture operations in Tennessee, and he is most worthy of our approbation; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend George McDonald upon his

exemplary career in farming, thank him for helping to preserve Tennessee's family farming tradition, and recognize his many contributions to this State's most important industry.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.